

Transparency Assessment

This assessment evaluates how effectively the Dryad dataset and associated repository materials support transparency, interpretability, and independent understanding of the research workflow. The review focused on whether another researcher could reasonably understand how the dataset relates to the published study without direct clarification from the original authors.

Transparency Strengths

Several aspects of the repository support transparency and responsible research sharing.

Repository Accessibility

The dataset is publicly accessible through the Dryad repository and supported by a persistent DOI. This improves discoverability, citation, and long-term access.

Connection Between Dataset and Article

The repository includes direct linkage to the associated journal article, allowing users to connect the deposited files with the published research findings and methodology.

Structured Dataset Organization

The dataset is organized in a structured tabular format using preservation-friendly CSV files, which supports readability and long-term accessibility.

Transparency Limitations

Despite strong repository access, several transparency limitations were identified during the curation assessment.

1. Limited Variable-Level Explanations

Some variables and coded values are not fully explained within the repository materials, making interpretation difficult without additional context.

2. Missing Workflow Documentation

The repository provides limited explanation of:

- preprocessing activities,
- transformation procedures,
- scoring calculations,
- and analytical preparation steps.

This reduces visibility into how the final dataset was produced.

3. Dependence on the Associated Publication

The associated article contains important methodological and interpretive information that is not fully preserved within the repository itself. As a result, independent understanding depends heavily on reading the article alongside the dataset.

4. Limited Provenance Transparency

Although repository-level provenance is available, detailed analytical lineage and transformation history are not fully documented.

Transparency Impact

These limitations do not prevent reuse, but they reduce how easily another researcher can:

- independently interpret the dataset,
- understand analytical decisions,
- evaluate transformations,
- or assess reproducibility using only repository materials.

The assessment therefore concluded that the dataset supports partial transparency but would benefit from stronger standalone documentation and workflow explanation.